CENTRUM

Banking

Credit Growth Accelerates Amid Deposit Constraints

System-level banking credit growth has maintained a steady upward trend. Recent fortnightly data show that system loan growth has strengthened from 12.0% YoY as of mid-December to 14.6% YoY by mid-March, while deposit growth has trailed at 11.1% YoY over the same period. This divergence has pushed the LDR to a record high of 83%. Against this backdrop, mid-sized banks and SFBs are expected to post relatively stronger advances growth. Asset quality trends are likely to remain favorable through the quarter, with credit costs continuing to ease on the back of contained slippages and improving collection efficiency. On the profitability front, earnings growth is expected to stay healthy, underpinned by steady fee income and declining credit costs. However, materially lower treasury gains driven by bond yield hardening are likely to weigh on overall profitability. While recent repo rate cut will exert some downward pressure on asset yields, lower funding costs, improved liquidity management, and balance sheet optimization should collectively help support NIMs across banks in Q4FY26, underpinning a broadly constructive operating outlook for the sector. Q4FY26 business updates have been particularly strong on the advances growth front. Within the UB space, we continue to maintain Axis Bank as our top pick, supported by relatively undemanding valuations and an attractive risk-reward profile. Among SFBs, Equitas (EQSFB) and Suryoday remain our preferred picks — as direct beneficiaries of the ongoing MFI upcycle, stronger operating leverage, and improving asset quality trends.

AXSB: Earnings expected to rise with lower credit cost

We project ~3.9% growth in NII on QoQ basis, lower than the growth in advances, with NIM expected to remain stable. Resultantly, PPoP is anticipated to see a rise QoQ at ~6.2% due to higher fee income and stable interest income. On the earnings front, the bank is likely to report a rise by 6.5% QoQ due to stable credit cost.

ICICIB: Higher NII and PPOP leading to higher growth in earnings

We project ~4.5% growth in NII on QoQ basis, higher than the growth in advances, with NIM expected to remain stable. Resultantly, PPoP is anticipated to see a rise QoQ at ~7.5% due to higher fee and interest income. On the earnings front, the bank is likely to report a rise by 14.2% QoQ due to improvement in credit cost.

IDFCBK: Earnings Expected to fall sequentially due to losses from fraudulent transaction

We expect NII to grow ~7.6% QoQ, outpacing advances and deposit growth, supported by a modest uptick in yields driven by a higher mix of unsecured lending, while cost of funds remains stable. However, PPoP is likely to decline ~18% QoQ due to losses related to fraud, which is expected to weigh significantly on profitability. As a result, the bank's profit is projected to decline by ~50% QoQ..

Federal Bank: We expect higher growth due to lower credit cost

We expect 3.8% QoQ growth in NII, with NIM likely to rise marginally to 3.23%. PPoP is set to rise around 4.3% QoQ, due to stable opex and CoF. Net profit is projected to rise by ~13.4% QoQ due to ~25% lower credit cost.

RBL: Earnings expected to rise on the back of lower credit cost

We anticipate an increase of ~5.6% QoQ in NII, at a slower pace than the loan book and deposit growth, as NIM is expected to remain stable at 4.8%. PPoP is projected to grow by 10.2% QoQ, driven by a 138bps fall in CTI. Earnings are expected to rise by 38.3% QoQ.

AUBANK: Provisional numbers indicate advances growth better than expected

We project 4.7% QoQ growth in NII, at a lower pace than the growth in advances and deposits. As yields are expected to be flat along with stable CoF. PPoP (up 15.6% QoQ) is expected to improve due to higher other income and stable CoF sequentially. Earnings are anticipated to increase by ~15% QoQ.

EQSFB: Expect higher profitability with lower credit cost

We estimate NII to grow by 10.5% QoQ, outpacing loan growth, as NIM is expected to expand by 28bps driven by lower CoF. PPoP is projected to rise 15% QoQ on the back of lower cost of funds. The bank is projected to post a profit of Rs1,383mn vs a profit of Rs900mn in 3QFY26.

Ujjivan: lower credit cost leads to rise in earnings

We expect NIMs to decrease by 16bps, as share of secured, lower-yielding products rise. As a result, NII is likely to grow sequentially. However, a rise in operating expenses is expected to drag PPoP, which will likely be lower by 3.8%. That said, net profit is projected to rise ~36.6% QoQ, largely driven by lower credit costs.

Suryoday: Higher NII and PPOP leading to higher growth in earnings

We expect NII to increase by 8.1% QoQ, driven by healthy loan book growth. PPoP is likely to increase by 14.7% QoQ, due to lower cost of fund. On the bottom line, the bank is projected to post a profit of Rs490mn vs. profit of Rs366 in 3QFY26.

Q4FY26 Results Preview

India I Banking

08 April 2026

Institutional Research

NIFTY 50: 23,997

BSE Sensex: 77,563

Stock price performance (%)*

Company Name	1 Mth	3 Mth	6 Mth	1 Yr
Axis Bank	3.5	3.0	9.9	27.2
AU SFB	3.9	(4.1)	26.8	78.7
Equitas SFB	5.0	(8.4)	5.2	11.0
Federal Bank	4.1	10.8	46.9	49.1
IDFC First Bank	(1.3)	(22.3)	(7.3)	16.6
ICICI Bank	2.4	(7.2)	(4.0)	1.7
RBL Bank	8.4	0.8	17.1	90.2
Suryoday SFB	5.4	(4.2)	(6.8)	27.5
Ujjivan SFB	9.5	0.4	19.5	66.3

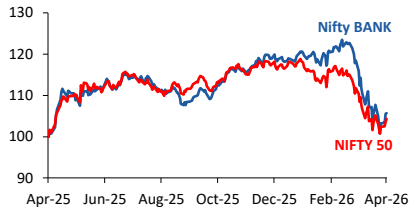
Source: Bloomberg; *as on 08TH April 2026

Rating and Target prices

Company	Rating	TP (Rs)
AXSB	Buy	1,460
ICICI Bank	Buy	1,760
AUBANK	Buy	1,208
EQSFB	Buy	80
FEDERALBNK	Neutral	305
IDFCBK	Neutral	80
RBL	Neutral	297
Suryoday	Buy	236
Ujjivan	Buy	73

Source: Centrum Research Estimates

Nifty 50 vs Nifty Bank



Source: Bloomberg

Banking

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Please see Appendix for analyst certifications and all other important disclosures.

Exhibit 1: 4QFY26 earning expectations

(Rs mn)	Net Interest Income					PPoP					PAT				
	4QFY26E	4QFY25A	YoY	3QFY26A	QoQ	4QFY26E	4QFY25A	YoY	3QFY26A	QoQ	4QFY26E	4QFY25A	YoY	3QFY26A	QoQ
Axis	1,48,513	1,38,105	7.5%	1,42,866	3.9%	1,15,467	1,07,524	7.4%	1,08,750	6.2%	69,134	71,175	-2.9%	64,888	6.5%
ICICI Bank	2,29,091	2,11,929	8.1%	2,19,322	4.4%	1,86,639	1,76,643	5.7%	1,73,560	7.5%	1,29,494	1,26,296	2.5%	1,13,179	14.4%
IDFCBK	59,114	49,076	20.5%	54,926	7.6%	16,396	17,948	-8.7%	20,095	-18.4%	2,408	2,956	-18.5%	4,787	-49.7%
FEDERALBNK	27,536	23,774	15.8%	26,527	3.8%	18,034	14,654	23.1%	17,293	4.3%	11,813	10,302	14.7%	10,416	13.4%
RBL	17,497	15,630	11.9%	16,572	5.6%	10,058	8,612	16.8%	9,124	10.2%	2,958	687	330.5%	2,139	38.3%
AUBANK	24,524	20,939	17.1%	23,413	4.7%	14,055	12,923	8.8%	12,153	15.7%	7,663	5,037	52.1%	6,677	14.8%
EQSFB	9,410	8,294	13.5%	8,516	10.5%	3,532	3,113	13.5%	3,072	15.0%	1,383	421	228.4%	900	53.6%
Ujjivan	10,380	8,643	20.1%	10,005	3.8%	4,598	3,598	27.8%	4,398	4.6%	2,460	834	195.0%	1,857	32.5%
Suryoday	2,993	2,447	22.3%	2,768	8.1%	1,021	466	118.9%	890.1	14.7%	490	-337	-245.2%	365	34.2%

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking

Exhibit 2: Profitability ratios

Profitability ratios	4QFY26E – Annualised									4QFY25 – Annualised									3QFY26 – Annualised								
Particulars (%)	Axis	ICICI	IDFCBK	FED BNK	RBL	AUBANK	EQSFB	Ujjivan	Suryoday	Axis	ICICI	IDFCBK	FED BNK	RBL	AUBANK	EQSFB	Ujjivan	Suryoday	Axis	ICICI	IDFCBK	FED BNK	RBL	AUBANK	EQSFB	Ujjivan	Suryoday
Yield on IEA	8.2	8.3	11.4	8.2	10.6	11.4	13.8	15.6	13.7	8.5	9.0	11.7	8.6	11.2	11.7	14.4	15.7	13.4	8.2	8.4	11.3	8.3	10.7	11.5	13.8	16.0	13.6
Cost of borrowings	5.1	4.5	6.0	5.4	6.0	6.5	6.9	6.8	7.4	5.3	5.0	6.3	5.7	6.3	6.7	7.4	7.2	7.2	5.2	4.6	6.1	5.4	6.0	6.5	7.0	6.9	7.4
Spread	3.1	3.8	5.4	2.8	4.7	4.9	6.9	8.8	6.4	3.2	4.0	5.4	3.0	4.9	4.9	7.0	8.4	6.2	3.0	3.8	5.2	2.9	4.6	5.0	6.8	9.1	6.2
NIM on IEA	3.6	4.4	6.1	3.2	4.8	5.6	7.2	8.9	7.1	3.7	4.5	6.1	3.1	5.0	5.7	7.2	8.6	7.0	3.7	4.4	6.0	3.2	4.8	5.7	6.9	9.1	6.9
Other income to assets	1.8	1.4	2.2	1.3	2.8	2.0	1.9	2.3	1.8	1.8	1.4	2.2	1.2	2.8	2.0	1.7	2.3	1.6	1.5	1.4	2.2	1.2	2.7	1.7	2.1	2.3	1.9
Cost/income	48.0	38.2	79.8	54.4	64.9	58.0	70.9	66.7	73.1	47.8	37.9	73.6	56.7	66.4	54.7	70.5	68.3	84.7	47.0	40.8	73.6	53.9	66.3	60.3	73.1	66.1	75.1
Cost/assets	2.6	2.1	6.4	2.3	4.6	4.3	6.1	6.6	6.2	2.5	2.1	5.9	2.2	4.7	*4.2*	*6.1*	6.7	7.0	2.4	2.2	5.8	2.2	4.6	4.4	6.3	6.7	6.4
Credit cost % of AuM	0.5	0.4	1.9	0.4	2.2	1.2	1.5	1.4	1.2	0.4	0.3	2.5	0.2	3.4	2.5	2.7	3.4	3.8	0.5	0.7	2.0	0.5	2.5	1.1	1.9	2.2	1.4
Tax rate	25.2	24.6	25.2	24.0	25.0	25.2	25.0	24.0	23.5	24.2	24.7	14.1	22.4	9.7	23.4	21.0	12.5	27.8	24.8	23.5	21.7	25.5	25.0	24.5	20.8	24.0	23.5
RoA	1.6	2.4	0.2	1.3	0.7	1.7	1.0	1.8	1.1	1.8	2.4	0.3	1.2	0.2	1.3	0.3	0.7	-0.9	1.6	2.1	0.5	1.2	0.5	1.6	0.6	1.5	0.9
RoE	14.3	16.4	2.1	12.8	7.2	16.6	9.1	14.2	9.6	17.2	17.9	3.1	12.5	1.8	13.6	2.8	5.5	-7.0	14.0	14.3	4.1	11.7	5.3	15.0	6.0	11.6	7.3
Debt/Equity (x)	7.4	5.7	7.4	8.4	8.8	8.2	8.4	7.0	7.7	7.6	6.2	7.6	9.2	8.0	7.9	7.5	6.7	6.9	7.5	5.6	7.0	8.7	8.3	7.9	8.1	6.8	7.2
Assets/Equity (x)	8.8	7.0	8.8	9.8	10.1	9.3	9.8	8.2	8.7	9.0	7.5	9.0	10.4	9.4	9.2	8.7	7.8	7.6	8.9	6.9	8.4	10.2	9.6	9.1	9.4	8.0	8.4

Source: Centrum Broking, Company Data

Exhibit 3: Summary Valuations

Company	EPS (Rs.)				ABVPS (Rs)				RoAA (%)				RoAE (%)			
	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Axis	85.1	79.3	110.9	132.7	568.4	648.3	761.6	888.6	1.7	1.4	1.8	1.9	15.9	12.8	15.4	15.7
ICICI	66.8	69.8	79.4	91.9	377.3	422.7	488.5	564.3	2.4	2.3	2.3	2.4	17.8	16.1	16.1	16.3
AUBANK	28.3	34.5	46.9	58.2	220.5	248.4	289.0	344.2	1.6	1.5	1.7	1.6	14.2	14.0	16.4	17.2
EQSFB	1.3	0.3	8.3	10.4	48.6	49.9	57.0	64.5	0.3	0.1	1.4	1.4	2.4	0.5	14.5	15.7
Federal	16.5	16.0	19.8	23.1	131.8	152.5	175.9	196.9	1.2	1.1	1.3	1.4	13.0	11.1	12.2	12.1
IDFC	2.0	2.8	5.2	7.3	50.4	54.3	58.8	64.7	0.5	0.6	0.9	1.0	4.2	5.5	8.9	11.3
RBL	11.4	13.9	12.5	15.4	253.4	262.8	283.1	296.3	0.5	0.5	1.1	1.0	4.6	5.3	6.4	5.3
SURYODAY	10.8	14.8	25.7	31.2	148.4	158.9	208.7	236.1	0.8	0.9	1.3	1.3	6.2	7.9	12.3	13.1
UJJIVAN	3.8	3.4	6.6	8.4	30.8	33.0	35.7	42.6	1.6	1.3	2.0	2.1	12.4	10.4	18.9	21.1

Company	CMP (Rs)	Rating	TP (Rs)	P/E (x)				P/ABV (x)				P/BV (x)			
				FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Axis	1,333	Buy	1,460	15.7	16.8	12.0	10.0	2.3	2.1	1.8	1.5	2.3	2.0	1.7	1.5
ICICI	1,309	Buy	1,760	19.6	18.8	16.5	14.2	3.5	3.1	2.7	2.3	3.2	2.8	2.5	2.2
AUBANK	970	Buy	1208	34.3	28.1	20.7	16.7	4.4	3.9	3.4	2.8	4.2	3.7	3.1	2.6
EQSFB	61	Buy	80	47.4	242.8	7.3	5.9	1.3	1.2	1.1	0.9	1.1	1.1	1.0	0.9
Federal	284	Neutral	305	17.2	17.8	14.4	12.3	2.2	1.9	1.6	1.4	2.1	1.8	1.6	1.4
IDFC	66	Neutral	80	32.5	23.7	12.7	9.0	1.3	1.2	1.1	1.0	1.3	1.2	1.1	1.0
RBL	323	Neutral	297	28.2	23.3	25.8	20.9	1.3	1.2	1.1	1.1	1.3	1.2	1.1	1.1
SURYODAY	139	Buy	236	12.8	9.3	5.4	4.4	0.9	0.9	0.7	0.6	0.8	0.7	0.6	0.5
UJJIVAN	59	Buy	73	15.6	17.3	8.8	7.0	1.9	1.8	1.6	1.4	1.9	1.7	1.6	1.4

Source: Centrum Broking, Company Data

Exhibit 4: Axis Bank Business Update

Axis Bank (Rs mn)	Q4FY24	Q1FY25	Q2FY25	Q3FY25	Q4FY25	Q1FY26	Q2FY26	Q3FY26	Q4FY26	YoY (%)	QoQ(%)
Gross Advances (End balances)	96,50,684*	98,00,915*	99,99,792*	1,02,59,000	1,04,08,113*	1,05,97,244*	1,12,84,000	1,17,05,000	1,24,42,000	14.1%	6.3%
Total Deposits (End balances)	1,06,86,414	1,06,24,837	1,08,67,440	1,09,59,000	1,17,29,520	1,16,16,150	1,20,35,000	1,26,08,000	1,33,58,000	13.9%	5.9%
CASA	45,94,010	44,44,790	44,10,530	43,29,000	47,81,880	46,81,660	47,90,000	49,31,000	52,89,000	13.9%	7.3%
CASA (%)	43.0%	41.8%	40.6%	39.5%	40.8%	40.3%	39.8%	39.1%	39.6%	-120bps	-50bps
Term deposits	60,92,404	61,80,047	64,56,910	66,30,000	69,47,640	69,34,490	72,45,000	76,77,000	76,82,000	15.8%	0.1%

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking *Net Advances

Exhibit 5: RBL Business update

RBL Bank (Rs mn)	Q4FY24	Q1FY25	Q2FY25	Q3FY25	Q4FY25	Q1FY26	Q2FY26	Q3FY26E	Q4FY26	YoY (%)	QoQ(%)
Gross Advances	8,56,400	8,84,550	8,97,860	9,27,400	9,49,730	9,67,040	10,23,500	10,45,020	11,54,880	21.8%	10.5%
Total Deposits	10,34,540	10,13,510	10,80,280	10,67,630	11,09,420	11,26,650	11,66,650	11,97,210	13,90,370	25.3%	16.1%
CASA	3,64,480	3,29,960	3,62,210	3,50,200	3,78,840	3,66,060	3,71,690	3,69,720	4,67,230	23.3%	26.4%
Retail LCR Deposit	4,31,390	4,99,800	5,22,230	5,37,030	5,52,120	5,79,290	5,94,410	6,16,320	6,39,430	15.8%	3.7%
CASA (%)	35.2	32.6	33.5	32.8	34.1	32.5	33.6	30.9	33.6		
LCR	140.0	137.0	129.0	143.0	133.0	152.0	127.0	125.0	130.0		

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking

Exhibit 6: AU Bank Business update

AUBANK (Rs mn)	Q4FY24	Q1FY25	Q2FY25	Q3FY25	Q4FY25	Q1FY26	Q2FY26	Q3FY26	Q4FY26	YoY (%)	QoQ(%)
Gross Advances	8,64,780	9,07,000	9,60,300	10,09,900	10,87,800	11,16,200	11,75,200	12,52,100	13,60,400	25.1%	8.6%
Total Deposits	9,77,040	9,72,900	10,96,900	11,22,600	12,42,700	12,77,000	13,25,100	13,84,200	15,26,600	22.8%	10.3%
CASA	3,14,560	3,20,340	3,55,200	3,44,000	3,62,500	3,72,400	3,89,600	3,99,500	4,33,600	19.6%	8.5%
CASA (%)	32.0%	33.0%	32.4%	30.6%	29.2%	29.2%	29.4%	28.9%	28.4%	-80bps	-50bps

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking

Exhibit 7: Equitas SFB Business update

Equitas SFB (Rs mn)	Q4FY24	Q1FY25	Q2FY25E	Q3FY25	Q4FY25	Q1FY26	Q2FY26	Q3FY26	Q4FY26	YoY (%)	QoQ(%)
Gross Advances	3,43,370	3,48,720	3,60,500	3,73,450	3,79,860	3,80,340	3,91,450	4,32,690	4,61,830	21.6%	6.7%
Total Deposits	3,61,290	3,75,240	3,98,590	4,07,380	4,31,070	4,43,790	4,40,940	4,36,680	4,65,330	7.9%	6.6%
CASA	1,15,520	1,17,240	1,21,840	1,16,680	1,24,100	1,30,530	1,36,220	1,28,860	1,21,980	-1.7%	-5.3%
CASA (%)	32.0%	31.0%	31.0%	29.0%	29.0%	29.0%	31.0%	29.5%	26.0%	-300bps	-350bps
Cost of Funds (calc./reported)	7.44%	7.5%	7.5%	7.5%	7.5%	*7.5%*	*7.4%*	7.1%	6.9%		

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking

Exhibit 8: Ujjivan Business update

Ujjivan SFB (Rs mn)	Q4FY24	Q1FY25	Q2FY25	Q3FY25	Q4FY25	Q1FY26	Q2FY26	Q3FY26	Q4FY26	YoY (%)	QoQ(%)
Gross Advances	2,97,790	3,00,910	3,03,440	3,04,660	3,21,220	3,32,870	3,45,880	3,70,550	4,06,550	26.6%	9.7%
Disbursements	66,810	52,860	53,740	53,600	74,550	65,430	79,580	83,110	97,630	31.0%	17.5%
Total Deposits	3,16,500	3,25,000	3,40,460	3,44,960	3,76,170	3,86,120	3,91,010	4,22,190	4,56,610	21.4%	8.2%
CASA	83,320	83,360	88,220	86,570	96,110	93,780	1,07,820	1,15,330	1,30,550	35.8%	13.2%
CASA (%)	26.30%	25.6%	25.9%	25.1%	25.6%	24.3%	27.6%	27.3%	28.6%		
Asset quality (%)											
GNPA	2.1	2.30	2.50	2.70	2.20	2.50	2.46	2.39	2.27		
PAR	3.5	4.30	5.10	5.40	4.50	4.80	4.45	3.98	3.54		

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking

Exhibit 9: Suryoday Business update

Suryoday SFB (Rs mn)	Q4FY24	Q1FY25	Q2FY25	Q3FY25	Q4FY25	Q1FY26	Q2FY26	Q3FY26	Q4FY26	YoY (%)	QoQ(%)
Gross Advances	86,500	90,370	93,600	95,630	1,02,510	1,08,460	1,15,440	1,18,100	1,32,010	28.8%	11.8%
Disbursements	23,400	17,400	16,260	14,670	21,010	22,610	24,300	26,980	30,770	46.5%	14.0%
Total Deposits	77,750	81,370	88,510	97,080	1,05,800	1,13,120	1,19,910	1,28,650	1,39,580	31.9%	8.5%
Retail (including CASA)	61,490	64,180	71,000	78,790	85,850	92,300	1,03,160	1,11,880	1,20,030	39.8%	7.3%
Bulk	16,260	17,190	17,510	18,280	19,950	20,830	16,750	16,770	19,550	-2.0%	16.6%
CASA	15,660	14,390	15,810	18,930	22,120	20,030	24,770	27,310	31,410	42.0%	15.0%
CASA (%)	20.1%	17.7%	17.9%	19.5%	20.9%	17.7%	20.7%	21.2%	22.5%		
Asset quality (%)											
GNPA	2.8	2.7	2.9	5.50	7.10	8.50	9.30	6.70	6.50		
Collection efficiency	100.6	101.0	98.4	94.8	92.3	97.1	98.9	99.4	99.6		

Source: Companies, Centrum Broking

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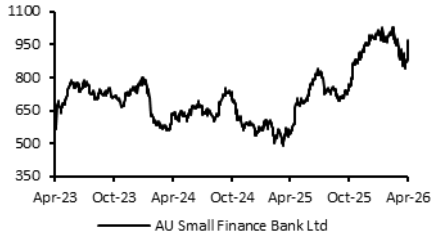
Axis

AUBANK



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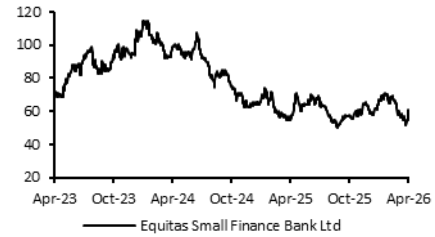

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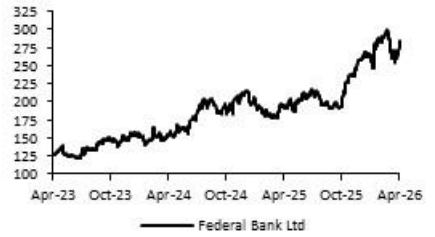

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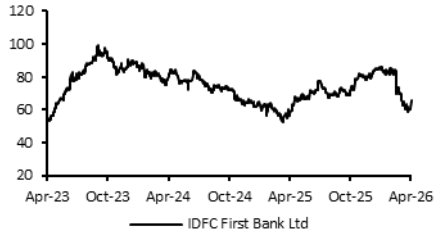

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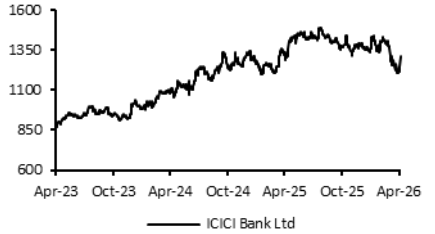

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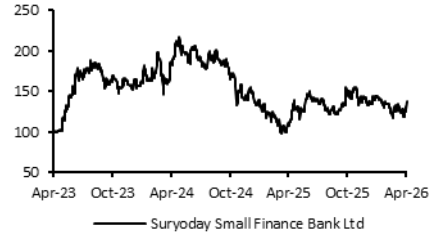
Suryoday



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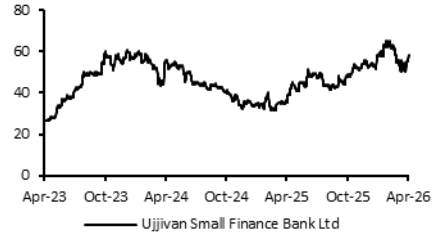

Source: Bloomberg

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